



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

karma tv eke praśaṃsanti svalpabuddhiratā narāḥ | BRP237.009.1
tena te dehaajālena ramayanta upāsate || 9 || BRP237.009.2
ye tu buddhiṃ parāṃ prāptā dharmanaiḥ puṇyadarśinaḥ | BRP237.010.1
na te karma praśaṃsanti kūpaṃ nadyāṃ pibann iva || 10 || BRP237.010.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 237: On the opposition of action and knowledge (Chapter 237), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Brahmapurāṇa, in this chapter, delves into the age-old debate between action (karma) and knowledge (jnana), offering profound insights into their respective roles in your spiritual journey. The verses highlight a critical distinction between those engrossed in worldly activities and those who have attained higher wisdom. It suggests that individuals with limited understanding often praise action alone, becoming entangled in the web of physical existence and finding pleasure in ritualistic practices. They remain confined to the cycle of birth and death, driven by desires and attachments.

However, the scripture contrasts this with those who have gained superior intellect and a deep understanding of righteousness. These enlightened souls, having perceived the true nature of reality, do not glorify action for its own sake. The analogy of someone digging a well (kupa) while standing next to a river (nadya) beautifully illustrates this point. Why would you laboriously draw water from a well when the abundant flow of a river is readily available? Similarly, why would you cling to the limited results of actions when the boundless bliss of knowledge awaits?

In modern life, this wisdom urges you to reflect on your priorities. Are you solely focused on accumulating material possessions and achieving worldly success, constantly striving for external validation? Or are you also cultivating inner peace and wisdom through self-reflection, contemplation, and the pursuit of spiritual knowledge? The Brahmapurāṇa encourages a balanced approach, recognizing the importance of both action and knowledge. While performing your duties and responsibilities with dedication, you should also strive to transcend the limitations of the ego and realize your true nature as pure consciousness. The scripture invites you to move beyond superficial engagements and seek the deeper meaning of existence. It's not about abandoning action altogether, but about performing actions with detachment, understanding that true liberation comes from realizing the oneness of all things.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are your actions driven by a desire for external rewards, or are they motivated by a genuine sense of purpose and a yearning for inner growth, and how can you shift towards the latter?